Example #10. Negative numeric indices

```
<?php
$string = 'string';
echo "The character at index -2 is $string[-2].", PHP_EOL;
$string[-3] = 'o';
echo "Changing the character at index -3 to o gives $string.", PHP_EOL;
?>
```

The above example will output:

The character at index -2 is n.

Changing the character at index -3 to o gives strong.

For anything more complex, you should use the complex syntax.

4.2.2 Complex (curly) Syntax

This isn't called complex because the syntax is complex, but because it allows for the use of complex expressions.

Any scalar variable, array element or object property with a string representation can be included via this syntax. Simply write the expression the same way as it would appear outside the string, and then wrap it in {and}. Since {cannot be escaped, this syntax will only be recognized when the $ immediately follows the {Use {\$ to get a literal {$. Some examples to make it clear:

```
<?php
// Show all errors
error_reporting(E_ALL);

$great = 'fantastic';

// Won't work, outputs: This is { fantastic}
echo "This is { $great}";

// Works, outputs: This is fantastic
echo "This is {$great}";

// Works
echo "This square is {$square->width}00 centimeters broad.";
```